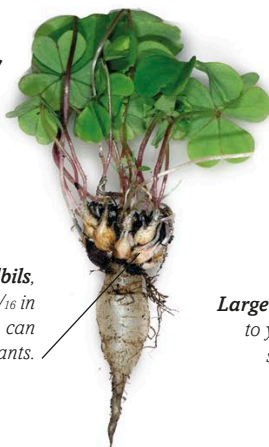




Blossoms and bulbs

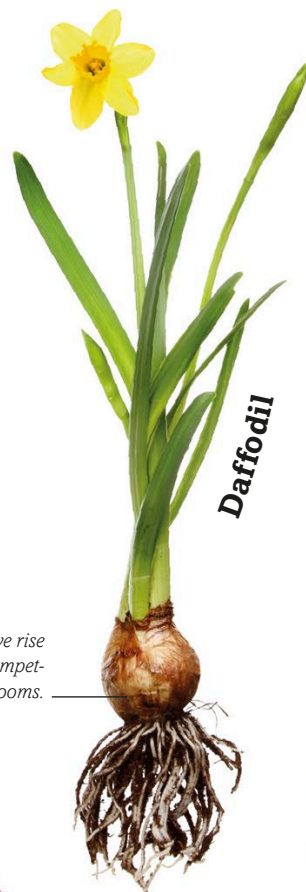


pink wood sorrel



Tiny bulbs called bulbils, which are $\frac{1}{4}$ – $\frac{7}{16}$ in (7–11 mm) in size, can grow into new plants.

Large flowers bloom before leaves grow from the bulb.



Daffodil

Large bulbs give rise to yellow, trumpet-shaped blooms.

Amaryllis



Amaryllis bulb

This bulb starts flowering about 6–8 weeks after planting.

Delicate, lilylike flowers are produced on leafless stalks.



Nerine



Nerine bulb

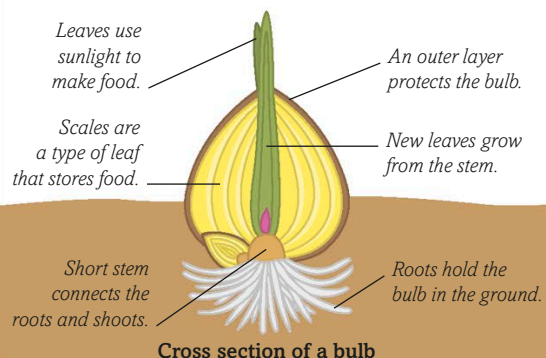
This bulb grows only in cool weather during the fall.

Each **wild leek** stalk can produce **more than 500** flowers.



UNDERGROUND STORE

A bulb is made up of a short stem that produces layers of fleshy leaves known as scales, which store food and water.



Cross section of a bulb

Some of our favorite flowers grow from underground food stores, called bulbs. Packed with food and water, bulbs lie dormant beneath the soil when the weather is either too hot or too cold, hidden from hungry animals. But as soon as conditions are right, they quickly sprout new shoots and leaves.